

Meeting summary — Jakarta EE Future Directions, July 24, 2025

Arjan Tijms joined the interest group to discuss the evolution of Jakarta Security, with a focus on Jakarta EE 12. He reviewed the history of security in Java EE and Jakarta EE, noting the shift from mostly container-managed security toward more application-programmable security while preserving existing container-managed models.

The main Jakarta EE 12 direction discussed was making authorization more consistent and easier to use. Arjan described plans to merge Jakarta Authorization, Jakarta Authentication, and Jakarta Security more coherently under the Jakarta Security umbrella, while still preserving vendor flexibility. A key proposal is a higher-level “permission store” model that would let applications programmatically add, remove, and manage permissions, reducing reliance on `web.xml` for URL-pattern constraints.

The group also discussed JWT and MicroProfile. Arjan explained that work has been done to bridge MicroProfile JWT into a Jakarta Security-style authentication mechanism, but the final direction depends on broader MicroProfile-to-Jakarta discussions, including namespace and compatibility concerns.

Questions covered whether Jakarta EE 12 may support declarative or programmatic mapping of authentication mechanisms to URL patterns. Arjan confirmed this is an active area of interest, including possible support for multiple authentication mechanisms, fallback behavior, and user choice among mechanisms such as OpenID, basic authentication, or social login-style flows.

There was also interest in SAML support. Arjan said SAML is not currently on the formal roadmap, but the Jakarta Security project would welcome contributions, especially since additional authentication mechanisms require community resources. The meeting closed with a call for contributors to help advance Jakarta Security work for Jakarta EE 12.